THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

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For athletes without an aid offer who still want to play. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the
2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
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For athletes without an aid offer who still want to play. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.

> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises admission, aid, an offer, a roster spot or playing time. Confirm every rule with each school's compliance and financial aid offices. `TO VERIFY` = we could not confirm against a primary source on 2026-11-05.

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1. WALK-ON TYPES

- **Preferred (recruited) walk-on:** a coach invites you, usually with an admissions or roster commitment but no athletics aid.
- **Tryout walk-on:** you enroll, then try out. Tryouts happen on the school's timeline.

These are common terms, not bylaw definitions.

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2. ROSTER LIMITS AFTER HOUSE

At D1 schools in a defendant conference or that opted into the House settlement, each sport has a hard roster cap (D1 Bylaw 17.2, adopted 6/6/25 eff. 7/1/25). Examples: football 105, baseball 34, softball 25, men's and women's soccer 28, women's volleyball 18, men's and women's basketball 15, cross country 17, track 45, men's wrestling 30, swimming and diving 30. The roster is submitted by the day before the first championship-selection contest or Dec 1, whichever is earlier (Bylaw 17.2.1), and an athlete can be added after that only if the team is under the cap (Bylaw 17.2.1.1).

What this means: a "spot" is a number. Ask where you'd sit inside that number.

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3. WHAT TO GET IN WRITING

- Am I on the roster submitted under Bylaw 17.2.1, or trying out?
- Will you support my admission?
- Any chance of aid later? (Ask; don't assume.)
- Practice access, gear, academic support: same as aided athletes?

4. ADMISSIONS TIMELINE

Walk-ons apply like any student. Hit each school's application and aid deadlines (school-set). If an invite depends on admission, apply on time anyway.

5. QUESTION SHEET

QUESTION	SCHOOL A	SCHOOL B	SCHOOL C
Preferred or tryout?			
Roster count at my position now			
Will I count against the 17.2 cap?			
Admissions support?			
Aid possibility, in writing?			

Commit checklist: [ ] answers in an email from the coach [ ] admission confirmed [ ] aid package reviewed [ ] compliance question asked [ ] backup school kept open

6. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual, LSDBi 90008, Bylaws 17.2, 17.2.1, 17.2.1.1 (checked 2026-11-05): https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008
- Which schools opted in to the House settlement: `TO VERIFY` per school with its compliance office.